

Art documentation is disappearing.

The Global Artist Registry Foundation exists to stop that.

W H A T C H A N G E D

In forty years, the record of art moved from paper to rented space.

- **1980s to 2000s**

Records lived on paper, office servers and single workstations. Ownership was obvious. Fragility was physical.

- **2000s to today**

Records live in gallery software, cloud drives, websites and inboxes. Ownership is a subscription.

The medium changed. The responsibility for the record never moved with it.

W H Y T H E A R T W O R L D M O V E D

The cloud gave the art world real advantages.

- **Access from anywhere**
Fairs, viewing rooms and remote teams working from one shared record.
- **Instant collaboration**
Galleries, registrars and photographers updating the same file.
- **No local hardware**
No servers to maintain, no backups to forget.
- **Continuous updates**
New features and integrations without migration projects.

T H E L I A B I L I T Y

Every one of those advantages depends on someone else staying in business.

- **Access from anywhere**
Until the account lapses, the contract ends, or the login is lost.
- **One shared record**
Held on infrastructure the artist does not own or control.
- **No local hardware**
And no local copy either.
- **Continuous updates**
Including the update that removes the export you needed.

T H E R E S U L T

The cultural record of our time is rented, scattered and undocumented.

01

Rented

The record sits on commercial platforms with no obligation to keep it.

02

Scattered

Images here, dimensions there, provenance in an inbox.

03

Undocumented

No permanent identifier, so the same work appears as several works.

C O N S E Q U E N C E S

When the record goes, four people pay for it.

Artists

A career becomes unprovable. Early work vanishes first.

Estates

Heirs inherit boxes and passwords, not an archive.

Collectors

Provenance gaps that cannot be closed after the fact.

Scholars

Catalogues raisonnés built on guesswork instead of evidence.

W H A T D O E S N O T E X I S T

There is no independent institution whose only job is to keep the record.

- **Software companies**
Serve customers, and are sold, pivoted or closed.
- **Galleries**
Document what they sell, for as long as they represent the artist.
- **Museums**
Document their own collections, not the artists' full output.

Libraries have this institution. Music has it. Film has it. Contemporary art does not.

G L O B A L A R T I S T R E G I S T R Y F O U N D A T I O N

A permanent, artist-authenticated archive, held by a foundation that cannot be sold.

Owned by the artist

The artist authenticates and controls their own record.

Held independently

A non-profit stichting with no commercial owners.

Built for 100 years

Redundant archival storage and open, structured metadata.

F O U R S T E P S

From scattered files to a permanent record.

STEP 01

Verify

Every account is tied to a verified identity, so the record has an author.

STEP 02

Document

Works, dimensions, editions, provenance, exhibitions, catalogues and CV in one structure.

STEP 03

Authenticate

The artist confirms each record. Registrars and galleries propose, artists approve.

STEP 04

Preserve

Permanent identifiers, archival storage, and open exports institutions can rely on.

W H Y A F O U N D A T I O N , N O T A C O M P A N Y

Structured to outlast its founders.

- **Dutch stichting**
Registered under Dutch law in The Hague. No shareholders, no distribution of profit.
- **Independent board**
Art-historical, legal and archival expertise. No single party holds controlling rights.
- **Public statutes and reporting**
Articles of association, non-distribution constraint and dissolution clauses are public.
- **Free for verified artists**
Funded by donations, supporting members, partnerships and grants. We do not sell art.

W H A T T H E A R T I S T G E T S

One record, many uses.

01 **Permanent identifier for every work**

02 **Catalogue with images and full metadata**

03 **Exhibition history and living CV**

04 **Public artist page and private portfolios**

05 **Provenance and location history**

06 **Correspondence and document archive**

07 **Structured exports for galleries and museums**

08 **Archival cloud storage**

09 **Approval rights over records added by others**

W H E R E Y O U C O M E I N

The record of this generation is still recoverable.

It will not be in twenty years. We are building the infrastructure now, while the artists are here to authenticate their own work.

Support

Fund the first decade and the endowment.

Partner

Museums, archives, universities, registrars,
artist organisations.

Refer

Introduce the artists and estates who need
this most.